

## THE CURE

### ROBERTH SMITH (1959-

English musician, singer and songwriter. Co-founder of the band, lead singer and guitarist and primary songwriter of the band. Cure is a British post punk rock band. **Post-punk** (originally called **new musick** is a broad genre of music that emerged in 1977 in the wake of [punk rock](#). Post-punk musicians departed from punk's fundamental elements and raw simplicity, instead adopting a broader, more experimental approach that encompassed a variety of [avant-garde](#) sensibilities and non-rock influences. Inspired by punk's energy and [do it yourself ethic](#) but determined to break from rock [cliches](#), artists experimented with styles like [funk](#), [electronic music](#), [jazz](#), and [dance music](#); the [production techniques](#) of [dub](#) and [disco](#); and ideas from art and politics, including [critical theory](#), [modernist art](#), [cinema](#) and [literature](#).<sup>[3][4]</sup> These communities produced [independent record labels](#), visual art, [multimedia](#) performances and [fanzine](#) (A **fanzine** (blend of *fan* and *magazine* or *-zine*) is a non-professional and non-official publication produced by [enthusiasts](#) of a particular cultural [phenomenon](#) (such as a literary or musical genre) for the pleasure of others who share their interest).

The co-founder of the band was Laurence Tolhurst. Smith's style and voice was a major influence in the music industry. He is distinguished by his dress and appearance - pale complexion, smeared red lipstick, sooty eye-liner, tangled black hair, baggy black clothes. This is an influence of Gothic rock culture. **Goth** is a [subculture](#) that began in the [United Kingdom](#) during the early 1980s. It was developed by fans of [gothic rock](#), an offshoot of the [post-punk](#) music genre. Post-punk artists who anticipated the gothic rock genre and helped develop and shape the subculture include [Siouxsie and the Banshees](#), [Bauhaus](#), [the Cure](#) and [Joy Division](#).

Their debut album *Three Imaginary Boys* (1979), second album *Seventeen Seconds* (1980) *Disintegration* (1989) which holds ratings till date, are noteworthy.

Our text is a video of Robert Smith's interview with Richard Skinner, British TV, Radio anchor. The show is named *Old Grey Whistle Test* commissioned by David Attenborough, produced by Rowan Ayers and aired on BBC2 from 1971 to 1988. In the interview Smith speaks about why he left Siouxsie and the Banshees, a British Rock formed in 1976. He also speaks about the critical and commercial response to The

Glove, a 1983 English musical collaboration and recording project by Robert Smith and Steven Severin. (**The Glove** was a 1983 English musical collaboration and recording project by the Cure's Robert Smith and Siouxsie and the Banshees' Steven Severin. They released one studio album, *Blue Sunshine*, in 1983 as part of Severin's solo deal with Polydor. The latter came up with the band name, the album title and the blue/yellow sleeve concept, as Smith had to leave the project before completion due to prior commitments with the Cure.

EXERCISE: